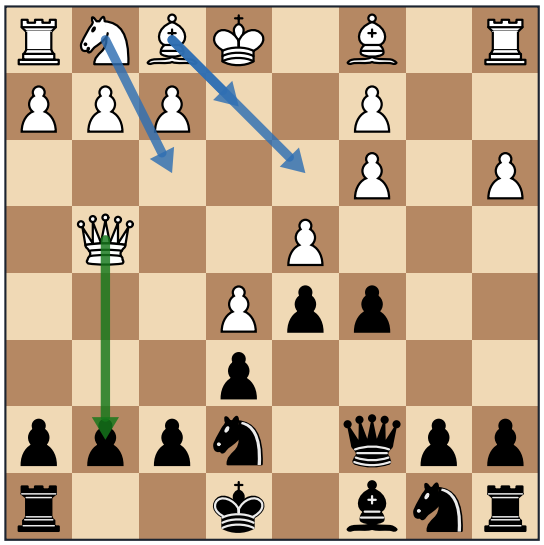
French Defense

ECO C00-C19 | 211 named lines | French family

In one sentence: A solid, counter-punching defense: Black accepts a cramped position for a strong pawn chain and clear plans.

Memory pattern: e6, d5, then c5 and f6: hit the base of the chain and free the light bishop.



Main line: 1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Qg4 Qc7

Key ideas

1. Attack the base of White's chain: ...c5, ...Nc6, ...Qb6 against d4.
2. Undermine e5 with ...f6 when White overextends.
3. Free the 'bad' light bishop with ...b6/...Ba6 or trade it.
4. White's plans are space, a kingside attack, or the Exchange for a quiet game.
5. The Winawer (3...Bb4) trades structure for activity and sharp play.

Reading the diagram

Blue arrows = thematic plan moves for the side to move. Green arrow = engine's best move.
Engine at the end of the main line: **+0.68** (slightly better for White, depth 19). Best: Qxg7.

The five coach questions

1. Ideal pawn structure?	Pawn chain e6/d5 against e5/d4 (Advance) or an open center (Exchange). Black's c8 bishop is the bad bishop; the d4/c3 base is the target for ...c5 and ...Qb6.
2. Where does my king go?	White usually castles kingside and attacks there; Black can castle either side but watch h7 and the f-file.
3. Best minor pieces?	Black: knights c6/e7, Qb6/c7, trade the light bishop. White: Bd3, Nf3, Qd2, kingside space.
4. Main middlegame plan?	Black hits d4 (...c5, ...Nc6, ...Qb6) and undermines e5 (...f6); White advances on the kingside or keeps the chain solid.
5. What does my opponent want?	White wants space and a kingside attack; Black wants the ...c5 break and an active light bishop.

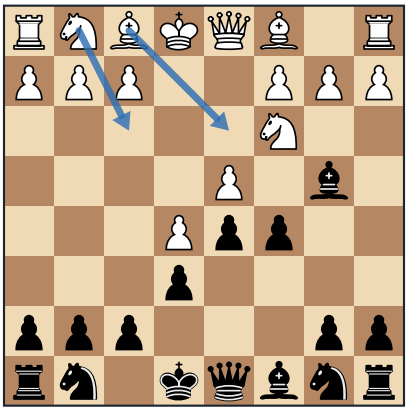
The main line, move by move

Most common continuation in the database: 1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Qg4 Qc7

Move	Why it is played
1. e4	Occupies the center with a pawn.
1... e6	Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break.
2. d4	Occupies the center with a pawn.
2... d5	Challenge e4. Occupies the center with a pawn.
3. Nc3	Develops the knight to c3.
3... Bb4	Winawer pin. Develops the bishop to b4.
4. e5	Gain space. Occupies the center with a pawn.
4... c5	Attack the d4 base. Pawn move that supports the center or prepares a break.
5. a3	Gains space on the wing.
5... Bxc3	Captures on c3 to trade or win material.
6. bxc3	Pawn capture: challenges the center and opens lines.
6... Ne7	Develops the knight to e7.
7. Qg4	Queen move: puts pressure on a target (watch for tempo-gaining attacks).
7... Qc7	Queen move: puts pressure on a target (watch for tempo-gaining attacks).



After 1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5



After 4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 c5

Key variations

The most important named branches (ranked by how much theory lies beneath them). Diagram arrows: blue = plan moves, green = Stockfish.

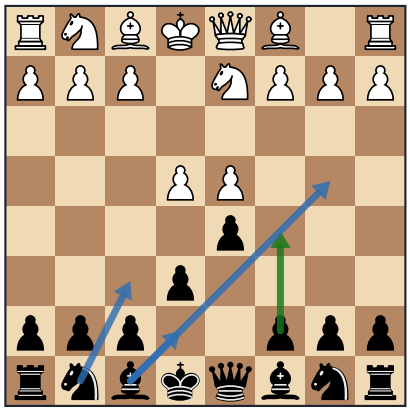


Position after the line

Winawer Variation C15 | 54 lines

`1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4`

Stockfish: **+0.73** (slightly better for White, depth 17). Best next move: e5.
What to look for: e5 (gain space); Nc3 (develop); Bd3 (aim at the kingside)
Sub-variations: Advance Variation, Positional Variation, Poisoned Pawn Variation, Fingerslip Variation

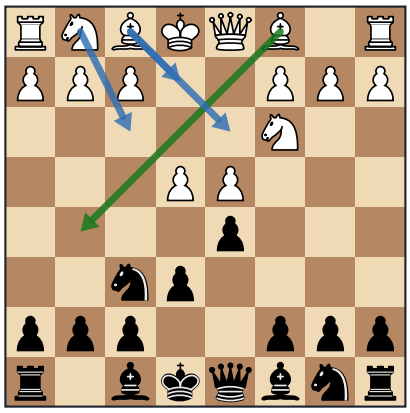


Position after the line

Tarrasch Variation C03 | 24 lines

`1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2`

Stockfish: **+0.33** (slightly better for White, depth 18). Best next move: c5.
What to look for: d5 (challenge e4); c5 (attack the d4 base); Nc6 (pressure d4)
Sub-variations: Open System, Guimard Defense, Closed Variation, Chistyakov Defense

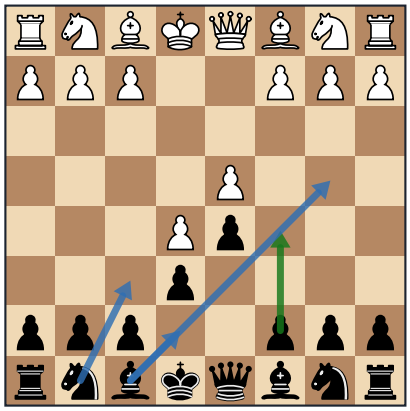


Position after the line

Classical Variation C11 | 23 lines

`1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6`

Stockfish: **+0.39** (slightly better for White, depth 16). Best next move: Bg5.
What to look for: e5 (gain space); Nc3 (develop); Bd3 (aim at the kingside)
Sub-variations: Burn Variation, Steinitz Variation, Richter Attack, Delayed Exchange Variation

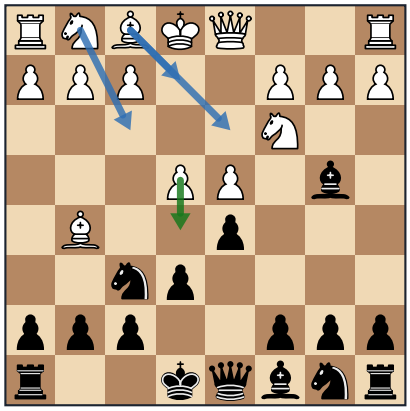


Position after the line

Advance Variation C02 | 22 lines

`1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5`

Stockfish: **+0.29** (slightly better for White, depth 17). Best next move: c5.
What to look for: d5 (challenge e4); c5 (attack the d4 base); Nc6 (pressure d4)
Sub-variations: Milner-Barry Gambit, Euwe Variation, Extended Bishop Swap, Frenkel Gambit

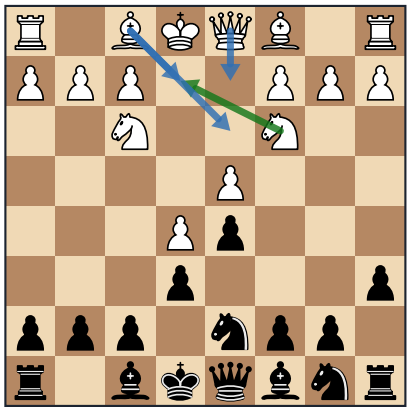


Position after the line

McCutcheon Variation C12 | 14 lines

`1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4`

Stockfish: **+0.56** (slightly better for White, depth 18). Best next move: e5.
What to look for: e5 (gain space); Nc3 (develop); Bd3 (aim at the kingside)
Sub-variations: Lasker Variation, Advance Variation, Bernstein Variation, Bogoljubow Variation



Position after the line

Steinitz Variation C11 | 9 lines

`1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 a6 4.Nf3 Nf6 5.e5 Nfd7`

Stockfish: **+0.49** (slightly better for White, depth 16). Best next move: Ne2.
What to look for: e5 (gain space); Nc3 (develop); Bd3 (aim at the kingside)
Sub-variations: Boleslavsky Variation, Bradford Attack Variation, Brodsky-Jones Variation, Gledhill Attack

Detailed repertoire notes

French Defense (C00-C19, Black)

`1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.Bxe7 Qxe7 7.f4 O-O 8.Nf3 c5 9.Qd2 Nc6 10.O-O-O a6`

Idea: Challenge the center with ...d5 and ...c5, accepting a slightly cramped position for strong counterplay.

Structure: French pawn chain: White e5/d4 vs Black e6/d5. Black's light-squared bishop is the 'bad piece'; improve it with ...b6 or ...Bd7.

Pieces: Knights to c6/e7, queen on b6/c7, dark bishop for activity. Black's rooks aim at the c-file.

Plan: Strike with ...c5 and ...f6 to undermine e5; trade the bad bishop and counterattack on the queenside.

King: Castle after ...Be7; be ready for ...f5 or ...Qb6 against Bd3/Qg4. **Opponent:** Space with e5, a kingside attack, and keeping d4 protected.

Watch out: In the Advance and Winawer, know the move orders: White may play for a king attack.

Expert and coach view

Botvinnik and Korchnoi were famous French Defense players.

What a coach would tell you

Pick your structure (Classical, Advance, Tarrasch, Winawer) and learn its two or three key plans well. The French rewards patience: do not rush ...c5 before your pieces are ready, and always know how your light bishop gets out.

Why play it

A solid, counter-punching defense: Black accepts a cramped position for a strong pawn chain and clear plans.

Typical mistakes

- Leaving the light bishop buried behind e6/d5 with no plan to free it.
- Castling into a Bxh7+ or Qg4 attack without ...f5 or ...Qc7 defenses.
- Letting White keep e5 and d4 both fully supported.

Typical tactics and traps

- Bxh7+ (Greek gift) after ...Nf6 and ...O-O with White's Ng5 and Qh5 ready.
- Qg4 attacking g7 in the Winawer, when Black grabs pawns.

Endgame and middlegame outlook

Endgames are often slightly better for White in the Exchange, but Black's solid structure and counterplay make the French hard to beat.

Study checklist

[ ] Play the main line on a board and say each move's purpose aloud.

[ ] Learn the five coach questions by heart; answer them without notes.

[ ] Drill two sub-variations until the moves feel automatic.

[ ] Play three games with the opening, then review where you left theory.

[ ] Re-read the traps page the day before a tournament.

The opening tree

Every named line in this family as a tree. Gray moves are inherited from the parent; green after the arrow are the new moves that define the variation. Large green dots mark branches with 10 or more lines.

- **French Defense (all lines)** — C00
  `1.e4 e6`
  - **Banzai-Leong Gambit** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.b4`
    - **Pinova Gambit** — C00
      `1.e4 e6 2.b4 -> 2...Bxb4 3.e5`
  - **Bird Invitation** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.Bb5`
  - **Chigorin Variation** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.Qe2`
  - **Horwitz Attack** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.b3`
    - **Papa-Ticulat Gambit** — C00
      `1.e4 e6 2.b3 -> 2...d5 3.Bb2`
  - **King's Indian Attack** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.d3`
    - **Franco-Hiva Gambit** — C00
      `1.e4 e6 2.d3 -> 2...f5`
  - **Knight Variation** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.Nf3`
    - **Franco-Hiva Gambit** — C00
      `1.e4 e6 2.Nf3 -> 2...f5`
  - **La Bourdonnais Variation** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.f4`
    - **Reuter Gambit** — C00
      `1.e4 e6 2.f4 -> 2...d5 3.Nf3 dxe4`
  - **Normal Variation** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4`
  - **Queen's Knight** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.Nc3`
  - **Réti-Spielmann Attack** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.g3`
  - **Steiner Variation** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.c4`
  - **Steinitz Attack** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.e5`
  - **Baeuerle Gambit** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 b5`
  - **Franco-Hiva Gambit** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 f5`
  - **Franco-Sicilian Defense** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 c5`
  - **Mediterranean Defense** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 Nf6`
  - **St. George Defense** — C00
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 a6`
    - **Three Pawn Attack** — C00
      `1.e4 e6 2.d4 a6 -> 3.c4`
    - **Sanky-George Gambit** — C00
      `1.e4 e6 2.d4 a6 -> 3.c4 b5`
    - **St. George Gambit** — C00
      `1.e4 e6 2.d4 a6 -> 3.c4 b5 4.cxb5 axb5`
    - **Traditional Line** — C00
      `1.e4 e6 2.d4 a6 -> 3.Nf3 b5 4.Bd3 c5 5.c3 Bb7 6.O-O Nf6`
  - **Advance Variation** — C02
    `1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.e5`
    - **Extended Bishop Swap** — C02
      `1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...Bd7`

- **Frenkel Gambit** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.b4
- **Nimzowitsch Attack** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.Qg4
- **Nimzowitsch System** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.Nf3
- **Steinitz Variation** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.dxc5
- **Kupreichik Variation** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Be3
- **Nimzowitsch Gambit** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.Qg4 cxd4 5.Nf3
- **Paulsen Attack** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Nf3
- **Ruisdonk Gambit** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.Nf3 cxd4 5.Bd3
- **Euwe Variation** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Nf3 Bd7
- **Wade Variation** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.c3 Qb6 5.Nf3 Bd7
- **Main Line** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Nf3 Qb6 6.a3
- **Milner-Barry Gambit** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Nf3 Qb6 6.Bd3
  - **Hector Variation** C02
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Nf3 Qb6 6.Bd3 -> 6...cxd4 7.0-0
  - **Main Line** C02
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Nf3 Qb6 6.Bd3 -> 6...cxd4 7.cxd4 Bd7 8.0-0
  - **Sørensen Variation** C02
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Nf3 Qb6 6.Bd3 -> 6...cxd4 7.cxd4 Bd7 8.0-0 Nxd4 9.Ng5
- **Lputian Variation** C02
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.e5 -> 3...c5 4.c3 Nc6 5.Nf3 Qb6 6.a3 Nh6

- **Alapin Gambit** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Be3
- **Diemer-Duhm Gambit** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.c4
- **Exchange Variation** C01
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.exd5
  - **Monte Carlo Variation** C01
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.exd5 -> 3...exd5 4.c4
  - **Svenonius Variation** C01
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.exd5 exd5 5.Bg5
  - **Bogoljubow Variation** C01
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.exd5 -> 3...exd5 4.Nc3 Nf6 5.Bg5 Nc6
- **Franco-Hiva Gambit Accepted** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 f5 3.exf5
- **Morphy Gambit** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nh3
- **Paulsen Variation** C10
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3
- **Pelikan Variation** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.Nc3 d5 3.f4
- **Perseus Gambit** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nf3
- **Schlechter Variation** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Bd3
- **Tarrasch Variation** C03
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2

- **Closed Variation** C05
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...Nf6
  - **Main Line** C06
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 Nf6 -> 4.e5 Nfd7 5.Bd3 c5 6.c3 Nc6 7.Ne2 cxd4 8.cxd4
- **Guimard Defense** C03
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...Nc6
  - **Main Line** C04
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 Nc6 -> 4.Ngf3 Nf6
  - **Thunderbunny Variation** C03
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 Nc6 -> 4.c3 dxe4 5.Nxe4 e5
- **Haberditz Variation** C03
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...f5
- **Modern System** C03
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...a6
- **Morozevich Variation** C03
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...Be7
- **Open System** C07
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...c5
  - **Euwe-Keres Line** C07
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 c5 -> 4.Ngf3
  - **Süchting Line** C07
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 c5 -> 4.c3
  - **Shaposhnikov Gambit** C07
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 c5 -> 4.exd5 Nf6
  - **Advance Line** C08
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 c5 -> 4.exd5 exd5 5.Ngf3 c4
  - **Main Line** C09
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 c5 -> 4.exd5 exd5 5.Ngf3 Nc6
- **Chistyakov Defense** C07
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...c5 4.exd5 Qxd5
  - **Modern Line** C07
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 c5 4.exd5 Qxd5 -> 5.Ngf3 cxd4 6.Bc4 Qd6 7.O-O Nf6 8.Nb3 Nc6 9.Nbxd4 Nxd4 10.Nxd4 a6
- **Pawn Center Variation** C05
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...Nf6 4.e5 Nfd7 5.f4
- **Botvinnik Variation** C05
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...Nf6 4.e5 Nfd7 5.Bd3 c5 6.c3 b6
- **Eliskases Variation** C07
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...c5 4.exd5 Qxd5 5.Ngf3 cxd4 6.Bc4 Qd8
- **Leningrad Variation** C06
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 -> 3...Nf6 4.e5 Nfd7 5.Bd3 c5 6.c3 Nc6 7.Ne2 cxd4 8.cxd4 Nb6
- **Two Knights Variation** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.Nf3 d5 3.Nc3
- **Classical Variation** C11
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6
  - **Delayed Exchange Variation** C11
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.exd5
  - **Steinitz Variation** C11
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.e5
  - **Swiss Variation** C11
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bd3
  - **Burn Variation** C13
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 dxe4
    - **Morozevich Line** C13
      1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 dxe4 -> 5.Nxe4 Be7 6.Bxf6 gxf6
    - **Main Line** C13
      1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 dxe4 -> 5.Nxe4 Be7 6.Bxf6 Bxf6 7.Nf3 O-O
  - **Normal Variation** C13
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7

- **Richter Attack** C13
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7 5.Bxf6
- **Shirov-Anand Variation** C11
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.e5 Nfd7 5.Nce2
- **Tartakower Variation** C13
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Ne4
- **Vistaneckis Variation** C13
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Ng8
- **Frankfurt Variation** C13
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Ng8 6.Be3 b6
- **Alapin Variation** C14
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.Bxe7 Qxe7 7.Nb5
- **Pollock Variation** C14
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.Bxe7 Qxe7 7.Qg4
- **Rubinstein Variation** C14
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.Bxe7 Qxe7 7.Qd2
- **Tarrasch Variation** C14
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.Bxe7 Qxe7 7.Bd3
- **Stahlberg Variation** C14
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 -> 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.Bxe7 Qxe7 7.f4 O-O 8.Nf3 c5 9.Qd2 Nc6 10.O-O-O c4
- **Diemer-Duhm Gambit Accepted** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.c4 dxe4
- **Hecht-Reefschläger Variation** C10
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nc6
- **Marshall Gambit** C10
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 c5
- **Rubinstein Variation** C10
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 dxe4
  - **Blackburne Defense** C10
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 dxe4 -> 4.Nxe4 Nd7
  - **Ellis Gambit** C10
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 dxe4 -> 4.Nxe4 e5
  - **Maric Variation** C10
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 dxe4 -> 4.Nxe4 Qd5
  - **Fort Knox Variation** C10
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 dxe4 -> 4.Nxe4 Bd7 5.Nf3 Bc6
  - **Capablanca Line** C10
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 dxe4 -> 4.Nxe4 Nd7 5.Nf3 Ngf6 6.Nxf6 Nxf6 7.Ne5
  - **Kasparov Attack** C10
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nd2 dxe4 4.Nxe4 Nd7 5.Nf3 Ngf6 6.Nxf6 Nxf6 7.c3
- **Winawer Variation** C15
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4
  - **Advance Variation** C16
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5
    - **Moscow Variation** C17
      1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 -> 4...c5 5.Qg4
    - **Smyslov Variation** C19
      1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 -> 4...Ne7 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 c5 7.a4
    - **with Bd3** C18
      1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 -> 4...c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Bd3
    - **with h4** C18
      1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 -> 4...c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.h4
  - **Alekhine-Maróczy Gambit** C15
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.Ne2
  - **Delayed Exchange Variation** C15
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.exd5
  - **Fingerslip Variation** C15
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.Bd2

- **Schwarz's Line** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.Bd2 -> 4...Ne7 5.Nb1
- **Kunin Double Gambit** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.Bd2 -> 4...dxe4 5.Qg4 Qxd4
- **Main Line** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.Bd2 -> 4...dxe4 5.Qg4 Nf6 6.Qxg7 Rg8 7.Qh6

- **Petrosian Variation** C16
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 Qd7
- **Alekhine Gambit** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.Ne2 dxe4 5.a3
- **Kan Variation** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.Ne2 dxe4 5.a3 -> 5...Bxc3 6.Nxc3 Nc6
- **Alatortsev Variation** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.Ne2 dxe4 5.a3 -> 5...Be7 6.Nxe4 Nf6 7.N2g3 O-O 8.Be2 Nc6

- **Bogoljubow Variation** C17
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.Bd2
- **Icelandic Defense** C17
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 c5 5.Bd2 -> 5...Ne7 6.f4

- **Alekhine Gambit Accepted** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.Ne2 dxe4 5.a3 Bxc3
- **Retreat Variation** C17
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Ba5
- **Armenian Line** C17
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Ba5 -> 6.b4 cxd4

- **Exchange Variation** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.exd5 exd5 5.Bd3 Ne7 6.Qh5
- **Canal Attack** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.exd5 exd5 5.Bd3 Ne7 6.Qh5

- **Kondratiyev Variation** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.Bd3 c5 5.exd5 Qxd5 6.Bd2
- **Winckelmann-Reimer Gambit** C15
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.a3 Bxc3 5.bxc3 dxe4 6.f3
- **Classical Variation** C18
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Qc7
- **Maróczy-Wallis Variation** C17
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.a3 cxd4 6.axb4 dxc3
- **Portisch-Hook Variation** C18
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Qa5
- **Positional Variation** C19
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Nf3
- **Eingorn Variation** C18
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Qg4 Kf8
- **Poisoned Pawn Variation** C18
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Qg4 Qc7
- **Main Line** C18
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Qg4 Qc7 -> 8.Qxg7 Rg8 9.Qxh7 cxd4 10.Ne2
- **Paoli Variation** C18
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Qg4 Qc7 -> 8.Qxg7 Rg8 9.Qxh7 cxd4 10.Kd1
- **Warsaw Variation** C18
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Qg4 O-O
- **Poisoned Pawn Variation Declined** C18
  1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 -> 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3 6.bxc3 Ne7 7.Qg4 Qc7 8.Bd3

- **Carlson Gambit** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nf3 dxe4 4.Ne5
- **Henneberger Variation** C11
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Be3
- **Orthoschnapp Gambit** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.c4 d5 3.cxd5 exd5 4.Qb3

- **Wing Gambit** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.Nf3 d5 3.e5 c5 4.b4
- **Hoffmann Gambit** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Qe2 e5 4.f4 exf4
- **McCutcheon Variation** C12
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4
  - **Advance Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.e5
  - **Exchange Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.exd5
  - **Wolf Gambit** C15
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.Ne2 Nf6 5.Bg5
  - **Bernstein Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.e5 h6 6.Bh4
  - **Chigorin Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.e5 h6 6.exf6
  - **Dr. Olland Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.e5 h6 6.Bc1
  - **Janowski Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.e5 h6 6.Be3
  - **Lasker Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.e5 h6 6.Bd2 Bxc3
  - **Tartakower Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.e5 h6 6.Bd2 Nfd7
  - **Bogoljubow Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.exd5 Qxd5 6.Bxf6 gxf6 7.Qd2 Qa5
  - **Duras Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.Nc3 d5 3.d4 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 5.e5 h6 6.Bd2 Bxc3 7.bxc3 Ne4 8.Qg4 Kf8 9.Bc1
  - **Grigoriev Variation** C12
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Bb4 -> 5.e5 h6 6.exf6 hxg5 7.fxg7 Rg8 8.h4 gxh4 9.Qg4
- **Reversed Philidor Formation** C00
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d3 d5 3.Nd2 Nf6 4.Ngf3 Nc6 5.Be2
- **Steinitz Variation** C11
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 a6 4.Nf3 Nf6 5.e5 Nfd7
  - **Gledhill Attack** C11
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.e5 Nfd7 5.Qg4
  - **Boleslavsky Variation** C11
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.e5 Nfd7 5.f4 c5 6.Nf3 Nc6 7.Be3
  - **Bradford Attack Variation** C11
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.e5 Nfd7 5.f4 c5 6.dxc5 Bxc5 7.Qg4
  - **Brodsky-Jones Variation** C11
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.e5 Nfd7 5.f4 c5 6.dxc5 Nc6 7.a3 Bxc5 8.Qg4 O-O 9.Nf3 f6
- **Alekhine-Chatard Attack** C13
  1.e4 e6 -> 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.h4
  - **Breyer Variation** C13
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.h4 -> 6...c5
  - **Maróczy Variation** C13
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.h4 -> 6...a6
  - **Spielmann Variation** C13
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.h4 -> 6...O-O
  - **Teichmann Variation** C13
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.h4 -> 6...f6
  - **Albin-Chatard Gambit** C13
    1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Nf6 4.Bg5 Be7 5.e5 Nfd7 6.h4 -> 6...Bxg5 7.hxg5 Qxg5

One-page memory sheet

Move-order pattern

```
1.e4 e6 2.d4 d5 3.Nc3 Bb4 4.e5 c5 5.a3 Bxc3
```

Plan chain

White	e5 -> Nc3 -> Bd3 -> Nf3 -> c3
Black	d5 -> c5 -> Nc6 -> Qb6 -> f6

Three rules to remember

1. e6, d5, then c5 and f6: hit the base of the chain and free the light bishop.

2. Black hits d4 (...c5, ...Nc6, ...Qb6) and undermines e5 (...f6); White advances on the kingside or keeps the chain solid.

3. White wants space and a kingside attack; Black wants the ...c5 break and an active light bishop.

Pawn structure in one line

Pawn chain e6/d5 against e5/d4 (Advance) or an open center (Exchange). Black's c8 bishop is the bad bishop; the d4/c3 base is the target for ...c5 and ...Qb6.